The Oslo talks were conducted as a secret intelligence operation of the highest order, without discussion or approval by the government or cabinet. They were run by a group of people who, in my humble opinion, were acting on behalf of themselves. I remember my reports to Yitzhak on the talks and his reactions. At first he would listen to my reports and not respond. Later he would respond to my reports by saying that he did not believe anything would come of it. At a later stage, whenever I reported to him, he would respond by saying, "I know about it." I would like to emphasize that my perception of my relationship with the prime minister was based on my understanding that I reported to him and that he had the right and the authority to respond—or not to respond—to these reports. Only rarely and in extreme cases did I ask for explanations, and in those cases, too, the decision whether to explain was his. It is also important to note that according to the intelligence community's "Magna Carta," the Mossad does not engage in intelligence gathering on and surveillance of Israelis. The Mossad personnel deployed in Europe, being skilled intelligence agents, came upon the Oslo talks incidentally and indirectly, and not by virtue of a mission assigned to them by anyone.

On the Palestinian issue in general, and with regard to the Oslo talks in particular, Rabin was passive and lacking faith, and he detested Arafat. We asked ourselves why, then, he gave his consent to Oslo, and one of the possible explanations was that Rabin assessed that if he were to refuse Peres's demand to allow him to advance Oslo, Peres would work within the Labor Party to oust him from his position.[1] We also found, from the same source, that on June 7, 1993, two and a half months before the signing of the Oslo Accords, Rabin sent Peres an official letter demanding that he stop the talks. He then retracted it. That same month, in June 1993, Rabin sent a high-level personal envoy to London for a meeting with Nabil Sha'ath, a member of the PLO's Executive Committee, to assess the credibility of the Oslo process.

Rabin's position on the Oslo process was also derived from the peace negotiations with Jordan, which were taking place at the same time and in which Rabin strongly believed. He thought that they had a very real chance of succeeding, greatly admired King Hussein, and took a very active role in leading the talks. The intensive diplomatic activity that took place in the second half of 1993 included not only the Jordanian and the Palestinian tracks but also the Syrian track. In early August 1993, Rabin gave US